VOLUME 5 — MOST EXPECTED QUESTION TYPES FOR THE UPCOMING NID DAT (20 Dec 2026)

> **Honesty statement:** nobody outside NID knows the actual questions. This volume ranks **question patterns** by probability, using (1) the official Handbook scheme, (2) the reported DAT 2024–2026 papers, (3) long-run repetition, (4) NID's education priorities (empathy, Indian context, sustainability, communication) and (5) the 2026 pattern change. **Every item below is [PREDICTION].**

1. Two scenarios for the paper

Scenario	Likelihood (my estimate)	Basis
S1: subjective-only, like 2026 (5–7 questions, multiple sub-parts)	~55–60%	The most recent actual paper; NID tends to repeat a new format for at least one more cycle
S2: Handbook scheme (22 objective + 4 subjective)	~35–40%	Printed in the Handbook text; used through DAT 2025
S3: something new (e.g. more writing, or a hybrid)	~5%	NID changes formats without notice

Implication: prepare drawing and ideation as the core (they matter in all scenarios), and keep the objective skills at about 85% accuracy as insurance.

2. Tier A — VERY HIGH probability patterns

A1. Scene drawing with people in a specific Indian setting or viewpoint

- **Why:** it appears almost every year; 2026 had a three-storey scene and perspective tasks; it tests observation, perspective, proportion and storytelling all at once.
- **Likely forms:**
  - "Draw a scene of ___ from the viewpoint of ___"
  - "a multi-level building with activities"
  - "a crowded place during a festival / monsoon / power cut"
  - "a view through a window / from a bridge"
- **High-yield practice prompts:**
  1. A railway station at 6 am from the footbridge
  2. A housing society during a water-supply hour
  3. A school canteen at lunch break
  4. A Diwali market lane at night
  5. A hospital waiting area seen by a child
  6. A bus stop in heavy rain

A2. Sequential drawing / storyboard with an empathy or social angle

- **Why:** 2026 (an elderly person falls on a morning walk) continues a long sequence-drawing tradition; NID increasingly emphasises empathy.

- **Likely forms:** a 4–6-frame story of help, an accident or rescue, a process (making something), a day in the life, a transformation.
- **High-yield prompts:**
    1. A child lost in a crowd and reunited
    2. A street dog injured in traffic being helped
    3. A blind person crossing a road with help
    4. The life of a discarded plastic bottle
    5. Grandparents learning UPI payments
    6. A farmer's day during a drought

A3. Product redesign / problem-solving for a specific user

- **Why:** 2025 (the neem branch, a train-related problem), 2026 (redesign, the grandmother's travel kit), and the long-run trend.
- **Likely forms:** "Identify problems faced by ___ while ___ and propose a solution"; "Redesign ___ for ___ (elderly, children, differently-abled, vendors)".
- **High-yield prompts:**
    1. A pressure cooker for elderly users
    2. A school bag for primary students
    3. A water bottle for construction workers
    4. A public tap for a slum cluster
    5. An auto-rickshaw for wheelchair users
    6. A clothes-drying solution for small flats
    7. A lunch-delivery box for hospital patients

A4. Visual communication set: signboards, posters, pictograms

- **Why:** 2026 asked for 5 signboards; 2025 a poster with a viewpoint constraint; posters and symbols recur.
- **Likely forms:** "Design N signs for ___"; "a poster for ___ using only ___ colours"; "a symbol for ___".
- **High-yield prompts:**
    1. 6 signs for a heritage site
    2. A poster for a water-conservation week, using only 2 colours
    3. Pictograms for a village health centre
    4. Safety signs for a school laboratory
    5. A poster for a local craft fair in a folk-art style

A5. Object from memory + written description (100–200 words)

- **Why:** 2026 asked for "a product you love + 200 words", plus food illustration; writing has risen as a component.
- **Likely forms:** "Draw your favourite ___ and describe its features"; "Draw an object you use daily and explain one improvement"; "Illustrate an Indian dish or drink with its ingredients".
- **High-yield prompts:**
    1. Your grandmother's kitchen tool
    2. A street food item with its cart
    3. A traditional toy
    4. A musical instrument
    5. Your school uniform's accessories

3. Tier B — HIGH probability patterns

B1. Unusual viewpoint / scale ("as seen by an ant / crow / fish / drone")

- **Why:** the 2025 crow's-viewpoint poster; imagination prompts recur.
- **Practice:**
    1. A cricket match seen by the ball
    2. Your classroom seen by a ceiling fan
    3. A pond seen by a fish looking up

B2. Imagination / "what if" scenarios

- **Why:** these test originality; they are classic NID prompts.
- **Practice:**
    1. What if all vehicles disappeared for a day?
    2. What if your shadow had its own life?
    3. What if plants could walk to water?

B3. Packaging / object-system design

- **Why:** a frequent product-plus-communication hybrid.
- **Practice:**
    1. Packaging for 4 kulhads for shipping
    2. Sustainable packaging for street-food takeaway

B4. Organising and listing visually (knolling, kits, flat-lays)

- **Why:** 2026's "items to carry with your grandmother" is a new pattern type that blends observation, empathy and layout.
- **Practice:**
    1. A first-aid kit for a trek
    2. A monsoon survival kit for a commuter
    3. A new-born baby's travel kit
    4. A kit for a first-time hostel student

B5. Colour and composition constraints inside drawings

- **Practice:** draw the same scene in a warm and in a cool palette; use only 3 colours; use complementary colours to highlight the focal point.

B6. Logo or symbol for a specific organisation or cause

- **Practice:**
    1. A logo for a women-run millet café
    2. A symbol for a city-wide cycling initiative

4. Tier C — MODERATE probability patterns (mainly if the objective Part I returns)

Pattern	Why it is still possible	How much to prepare
Visual reasoning MCQs (folding, cubes, mirror, counting, series)	2016–2025 papers had them; the Handbook still lists objective questions	Vol 4B to 85%+ accuracy
Logo identification / brand awareness	Reported in 2025	Vol 2C §9 and the flashcards
Indian craft / textile / art-form identification	Long-run GK items; also feeds the subjective work	Vol 2C §2–4
Observation detail questions (e.g. "how many spokes...")	Old GAT favourite	Vol 2A §3.1
Design-awareness MCQs (designers, movements, architecture)	Older papers	Vol 4G (skim)
Maths-lite / logic puzzles	Very occasional	Vol 4D (light)
Current affairs MCQs	Rare in recent Prelims; useful for the interview	Vol 11

5. Expected "twists" to be ready for

1. **Count constraints:** "exactly 5", "6 frames", "200 words". Missing the count costs marks.
2. **Viewpoint constraints:** a crow's view, a bird's-eye view, from inside an object.
3. **User constraints:** elderly, children, visually impaired, vendors, migrants.
4. **Material or colour constraints:** "using only lines", "monochrome", "only 3 colours".
5. **Mixed-mode answers:** drawing + labels + a written justification.
6. **Multi-part questions:** (a) identify problems, (b) sketch 3 ideas, (c) develop one in detail.

6. A high-yield 20-question drill set (do one a day for 20 days)

Time each at the given minutes and self-score using Vol 3 §13's rubric.

#	Prompt	Time	Tests
1	A three-storey building section showing four different family activities and one connecting event	25	Perspective, story
2	Six frames: helping a cyclist who has fallen after hitting a pothole, ending with a systemic fix	25	Sequence, empathy
3	Redesign a steel bucket for an elderly person with arthritis (3 ideas + 1 developed)	25	Product, ergonomics
4	5 signboards for a busy market lane (consistent system + 1 in context)	20	Signage
5	Draw your favourite kitchen object and write 150 words about it	20	Memory, writing
6	A poster for a lemonade stall from a pigeon's viewpoint	20	Viewpoint, poster
7	Items for a 2-day trip with a toddler, knolled + an organiser design	20	Kit, empathy
8	A narrow lane in an old city at dusk, 1-point perspective, with 6+ people	20	Perspective
9	A symbol for "free drinking water" that works without text	10	Pictogram
10	Illustrate a glass of masala chai with its ingredients and a tea-stall context	15	Food illustration
11	What if your school bag could talk? 4-frame comic	15	Imagination
12	Packaging for 6 handmade soaps with zero plastic	20	Packaging

#	Prompt	Time	Tests
13	Problems of a street cobbler during the monsoon; propose 1 solution	20	Problem-solving
14	A rooftop on kite-festival day, bird's-eye view	20	3-point perspective
15	A poster for a blood-donation camp using only red, black and white	15	Colour constraint
16	Redesign a hospital bed-side table for patients who can't sit up	20	Product, empathy
17	Draw a bicycle from memory; then label 10 parts	15	Memory accuracy
18	Six pictograms for a railway station, in a consistent style	20	Icon system
19	Your neighbourhood 50 years in the future	20	Speculative design
20	Two neighbours share one parking space; draw a fair solution	20	Conflict resolution

7. Pre-solved model approaches for 5 Tier-A questions

Q1. "Draw a three-storey building and show life on every floor." (20 marks, 30 min)

- *Plan (3 min):* a section view with the front wall removed. Ground floor: a kirana shop with a customer. 1st floor: a family dinner, with the TV on. 2nd floor: a student studying late under a lamp. Terrace: a grandmother drying papad, water tanks, a dish antenna. **Connecting thread:** a cat chasing a ball of wool down the staircase across all floors.
- *Execute (22 min):* a frontal 1-point layout with the VP at the 1st-floor eye level. Keep the floor heights consistent (about 1.7 adult heights). Draw people in gesture first, then add the details that show life (utensils, schoolbooks, clothes line).
- *Finish (5 min):* light colour, a dark outline for the building section, and a short title.
- *Scoring focus:* perspective, proportion, the variety of activities, storytelling (the cat), and Indian context details.

Q2. "Six frames: an elderly person falls during a morning walk." (20 marks, 25 min)

- Use the plan in Vol 3 §10. The key to a high score is **frame 6**, a systemic improvement (the fixed paving, a sign, a railing), which demonstrates design thinking beyond the story.

Q3. "Draw items you would carry when travelling with your grandmother." (15 marks, 20 min)

- *Layout:* a knolled grid of 12 items, each labelled:
  - medicines
  - pill organiser
  - spectacles
  - shawl
  - neck pillow
  - water bottle with a sipper
  - snacks
  - phone with big buttons
  - ID/ticket pouch
  - walking stick
  - torch
  - sanitiser
- *Add value:* a final "Gran's Travel Pouch" design. Colour-coded compartments, large-print tags, a cross-body strap so her hands stay free, a reflective strip, and a bright colour so it's easy to find.
- *Scoring focus:* completeness, empathy, and the organising design.

Q4. "Design 5 signboards for narrow streets." (15 marks, 20 min)

- *System:* all signs are blade signs. Rounded rectangles, a bold icon on top, a bilingual word below; blue for information, red for prohibition, yellow for warning.
- *The five signs:*
    1. One-way lane (arrow)
    2. No four-wheelers (crossed car)
    3. Low overhead wires (a person under a zig-zag line)
    4. Dead end ahead (a T-bar)
    5. Public tap / toilet → 50 m (icon + arrow)
- *Context drawing:* one lane in 1-point perspective with the signs mounted at about 2.4 m.

Q5. "Draw a product you love and write 200 words." (20 marks, 25 min)

- Use the template and model answer in Vol 2B §3.5. Choose a product whose form you know well. Draw a 3/4 view plus a usage inset; write within 180–220 words.

NEXT VOLUME: Volume 6 — Model Paper 1 (`06-VOL6-MODEL-PAPER-1.md`)